

Andrew De Spain

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Technical Artist recently contributing to *Halo: Campaign Evolved* and the first-person shooter *Shrapnel*. Integrated, rigged, and tuned Halo's iconic Warthog; built pipeline tools to support artists, reducing batch Unreal import times from 14 hours to 10 minutes (84× faster); and developed batch workflows to accurately retarget 2,000+ character animations.

Experience

Halo Studios (Aquent LLC) - Halo Campaign Evolved

Technical Artist | December 2024 - Present

- Delivered Halo's iconic Warthog fully rigged, tuned, and optimized within two weeks for an executive-level gameplay demo, earning recognition for its quality and execution.
- Reduced Unreal batch import times from 14 hours to 10 minutes (84× faster) by developing an optimized batch import workflow.
- Developed pipeline and animation tools supporting animation and art teams, including a USD-based Vignette Diorama tool, simple and complex collision generators, mocap measurement tools, a custom Unreal Interchange system, and more.
- Integrated 10+ iconic Halo vehicles and characters to a playable state, including the Warthog, Wraith, Seraph, Ghost, Banshee (Space), Elite, Hunter, Sentinel, Flood Marine, and Flood Elite.
- Built, designed, and integrated 148 destruction and debris FX pieces across six iconic Halo assets including the Warthog, Wraith, Seraph, Hunter, Sentinel, and Banshee and maintained, updated, and debugged them throughout production.
- Authored 700+ collision and physics meshes for Halo characters and vehicles using manual workflows and custom-developed tools for integration into Halo Studios' hybrid Unreal pipeline.
- Developed asset-archaeology tools to recover and modernize legacy content, including automated batch retargeting for 2,000+ character animations and automated export/import pipelines for legacy collision assets.
- Cinematic Groom for Cortana's hair.
- Researched, prototyped, and evaluated technical workflows across NVIDIA Audio2Face, SGX runtimes, procedural collision generation, Unreal Engine Interchange, and asset import performance, identifying opportunities for automation, optimization, and improved artist workflows.

Neon Machine - Shrapnel

Technical Artist (Rigging) | August 2023 - September 2024

- Engineered a Python/PyQt clothing pipeline to automatically categorize, rename, organize, and export clothing assets at scale, reducing a 2-3 hour manual workflow to seconds.
- Owned technical support for Shrapnel's character customization pipeline, skinning, weight-painting, and integrating 50+ sci-fi and military clothing assets into Unreal Engine and the in-game customization system.
- Researched and developed technical solutions for character customization, engine integration, and automated icon rendering workflows supporting hundreds of customizable weapon and character skins.

Brigham Young University – Student Capstone Projects

Rigging TD & Technical Animator | January 2022 - June 2023

- Led and mentored a team of five Technical Directors, establishing rigging workflows and ensuring character rigs met animation teams' creative and technical requirements.
- Developed 17+ character and mechanical rigs across four game and film productions, including facial, biped, quadruped, mechanical, and prop rigs.

Shipped Projects

Halo: Campaign Evolved

XBOX X|S, PLAYSTATION 5, PC
July 28, 2026

SHRAPNEL

PC
Mar 12, 2026

Competencies

Technical Skills: Unreal Engine • Maya • Python • PyQt • Blueprints • Maya Rigging • UE Control Rig • Animation Retargeting • Character and Vehicle Integration • Collision and Physics Meshes • Mesh and LOD Generation (Havok, Simplygon) • Destruction Systems • Skinning and Weight Painting • Pipeline Development • Proprietary Engines • AI

Production: Perforce • Jira • Adobe Creative Suite

Education

Brigham Young University

Bachelor of Fine Arts
August 2019 - May 2023

Salt Lake Community College

Associate of Science
January 2016 - April 2019

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This will allow you to view project breakdowns and visit my resume page.

